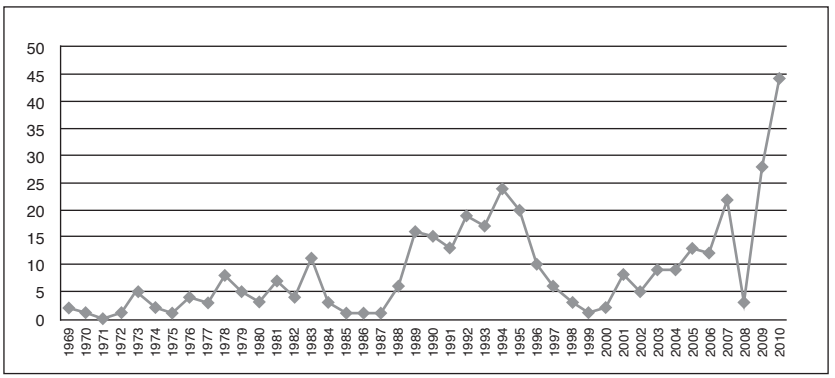
Figure 3. Overseas contracts signed by Brazilian contractors, by year



Source: prepared by the author.

contractors as the contracts are usually very lucrative.

With this information, it is possible to observe the ratio of Brazilian firms' incidence within each continent. Thus, from Table 2, one can see how the presence of Brazilian contractors is more generalised among the various countries of South America, North America, Central America and Africa than in Europe or Asia, where their incidence is restricted to only a few countries.

Finally, with this data and according to what one is able to observe, if the Brazilian contractors' internationalisation process is an intense, consolidated and proven movement on various continents and in various countries of the world, it is also marked by a high geographical concentration in a few regions and countries, such as South America, Africa and Central America along with the United States and Portugal. Even though the incidence of Brazilian contractors is significant in these places, its presence in European, Asian and Oceanic markets is practically nil.

Beyond the geography of this internationalisation process, there are a number of questions of a historical order that affect the Brazilian construction firms' performance. Thus, using Figure 3, one can see the trajectory of the quantity of contracts established by them abroad from 1969 to the end of the Lula da Silva government in 2010.

In the first place, it is necessary to highlight that in these cases the data is not totally reliable. In spite of a majority of the 368 contracts having clear indications of when they were signed, we were not able to get this information from the sources consulted for all of them. So we made deductions in some cases since the firms or journals researched did not exactly indicate the year but usually the length of time of the work and the period when the contract was signed.